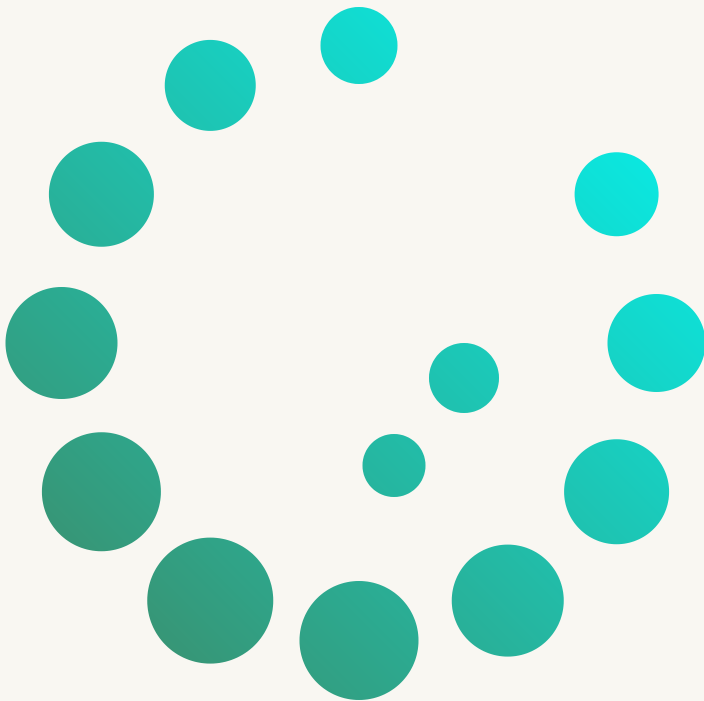


# DORA Research Brand Book

An applied AI lab and its first product. Two grounds, one company: Paper for the lab, Night for Zora.



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# Agents take the work. People keep the judgment.

DORA Research is an applied AI lab. We build agents that take over specific operational work in engineering organizations, and we say plainly which work that is. People keep judgment and accountability; the agents keep the record, the watch, and the follow-through. Our research, benchmarks, and frameworks are published before they become products.

THE LAB

## DORA Research

Publishes research. Holds the family mark. Signs every product page. Speaks as "we".

THE FIRST PRODUCT

## Zora

A technical director and chief of staff who reports to the CTO. Speaks as "I". She, never it.

THE PROMISE

## Ship faster. Break less.

Delivery is the promise. Memory is the mechanism, never what she is for.

# Version 1 documented the site.

# Version 2 documents the brand.

| SUBJECT           | VERSION 1                    | VERSION 2                                                                    | SOURCE      |
|-------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| The company       | The company behind Zora      | An applied AI lab with a family of products. Zora is the first.              | Q10, Q16    |
| What Zora is      | A second brain for work      | A technical director and chief of staff reporting to the CTO                 | Q9          |
| The promise       | Organizational memory        | Ship faster, break less. Memory is the mechanism.                            | Q2          |
| The person        | Product and technology teams | The CTO or VP Engineering, buyer and daily user                              | Q5          |
| The central scene | Can Atlas still ship Friday? | 06:00. A CTO reads the night brief.                                          | Q6, Q14     |
| Voice             | Calm, precise, credible      | A four-part brief in a technical director's manner. Zora is she.             | Q7, Q8, Q15 |
| Visual system     | One register: Porcelain      | Two registers: Paper for the lab, Night for Zora                             | Q13         |
| The mark          | The company mark, decorative | The lab's mark: thirteen specialists, one seat open. Products get their own. | Q11         |
| Research          | Not addressed                | Published before it ships. First framework: The Accountability Line v0.1.    | Q4, Q16     |

# A lab, and the specialists it ships.

DORA Research is the parent. Every product is a named specialist with its own mark, its own register, and one job. Neither mark ever stands in for the other.

| THE LAB                                                                                                                                                                                       | FIRST PRODUCT                                                                                                                                                                                                 | NEXT SPECIALISTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div> <b>DORA Research</b></div> <p>Publishes research. Holds the family mark. Signs every product page.</p> | <div> <b>Zora</b></div> <p>Technical director and chief of staff to the CTO. Night register. Mark proposed on page 26.</p> | <div> <b>Unnamed</b></div> <p>Each takes the swarm's open seat with a different chord. Each gets a name, a register, and a published framework before launch.</p> |

| WRITE                                              | NEVER                                         | WHERE                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>DORA Research</b>                               | Dora Research · DORA research · D.O.R.A.      | Masthead, footer, legal, bylines. First mention: an applied AI lab.    |
| <b>Zora</b>                                        | ZORA · zora · the Zora · Zora AI · it         | The subject of her sentences: Zora reads, Zora found, Zora recommends. |
| <b>Zora by DORA Research</b>                       | DORA's Zora · Zora from DORA                  | The attribution line on every product surface.                         |
| <b>a technical director who reports to the CTO</b> | copilot · assistant · second brain · teammate | What Zora is, in one clause. The reporting line is the positioning.    |

# Two words from engineering. One from a ship's mind.

DORA

## Throughput and stability

From the DORA metrics popularized by Google's DevOps Research and Assessment team: two dimensions of software delivery. The lab adds a third measure of its own, quality, and judges its products by all three.

RESEARCH

## Published before it ships

Applied research in the ElevenLabs sense: benchmarks and frameworks first, then the product that proves them. Research is upstream of everything the lab ships.

ZORA

## The ship's mind

After the sentient system in Star Trek Discovery that keeps a critical vessel and its crew alive. The idea travels. The imagery does not. Nothing in the brand is science fiction.

SAY THE WORDS

AI and agents, plainly. Never copilot, assistant, or chatbot. Never "our AI" or "the system" when the subject is Zora.

# Three measures, in the customer's own numbers.

THROUGHPUT

## How fast the organization ships

Lead time and deployment frequency, in the customer's own numbers, never the lab's.

STABILITY

## How safely it ships

Change failure rate and time to restore. The night brief exists to move these.

QUALITY

## Whether it was right

Decisions that hold, incidents that do not recur, briefs a CTO would forward.

TWO ENEMIES

## The status meeting that reconstructs last week.

The past you should already have.

## Being caught off guard.

The future you should have seen.

ONE FEELING

## Calm and in control.

It is 06:04. The CTO has finished the brief and knows exactly which question to ask first. That sentence is the test for every screen, every line, and every second of film.

# What the agents take. What people keep.

AGENTS TAKE

---

The overnight reading: the deploys, the alerts, the tickets, the threads, in the systems a person has opened to the agent

---

The record: what happened, in what order, linked to what was decided

---

The watch: conditions that match a pattern the organization has seen before

---

The follow-through: the ticket, the page, the hold, once a person has written the rule

---

PEOPLE KEEP

---

Judgment: the decision, made by a named person with the authority to make it

---

Accountability: the name in the incident review is never "the agent"

---

The rule: agents apply what people wrote and stop where the writing stops

---

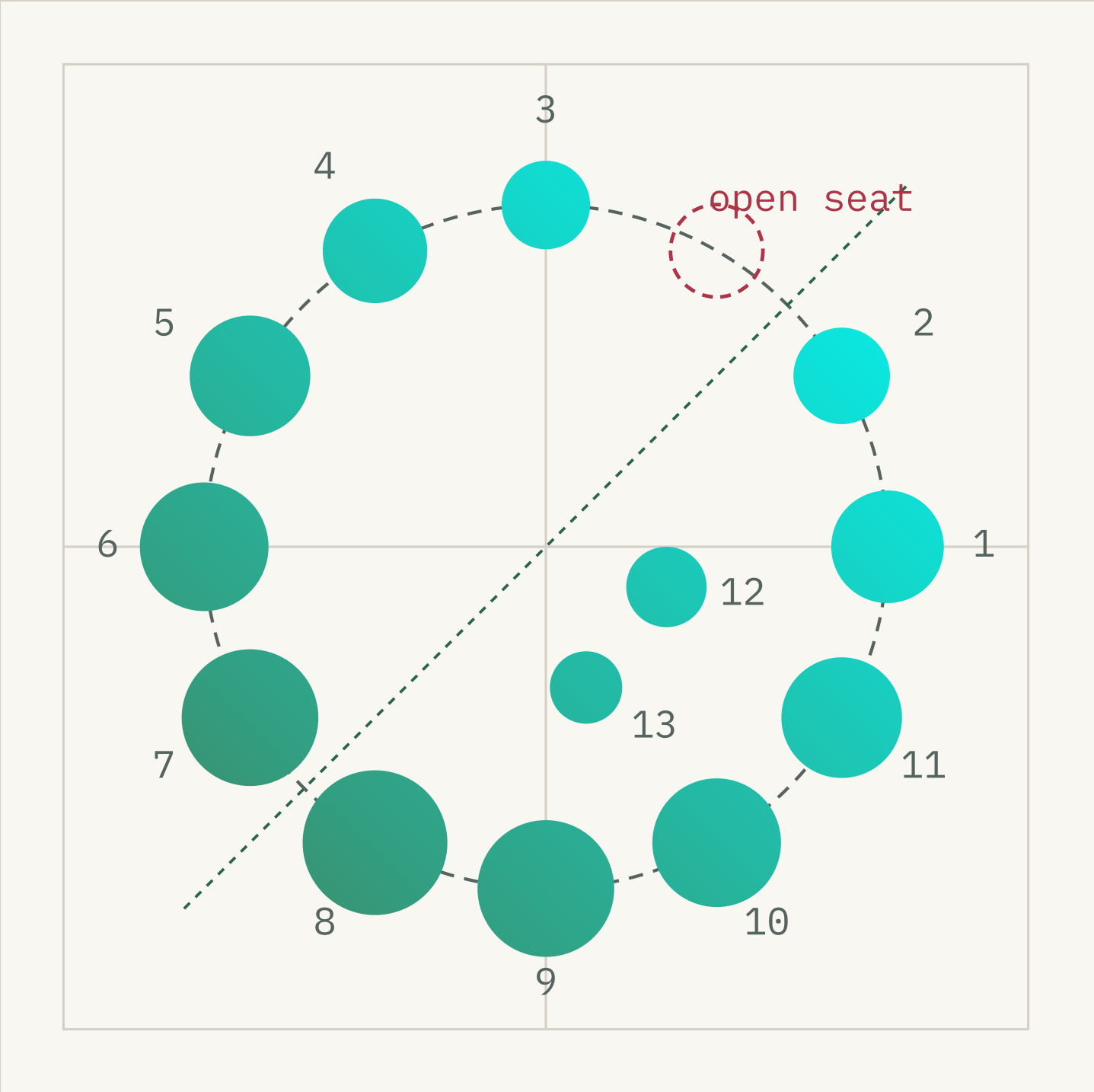
The line itself: which work is delegated is decided in the open and recorded

---

|

The lab publishes where the line sits and moves it only on evidence. That is the research program, the brand position, and Zora's operating contract in one sentence.

# Thirteen specialists in orbit. One seat open.



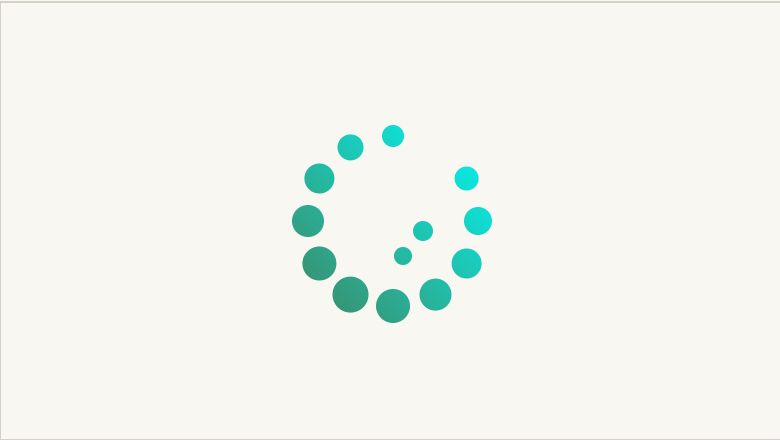
A swarm of thirteen agents, each with one job, in orbit around a center that is not drawn. Dot size grows along the orbit so the swarm reads as motion even when still. The gradient runs from the heaviest dots to the lightest, so the brightest color lands beside the opening. The open seat at the upper right is where the next specialist stands.

| DOT | CX    | CY    | R    | DOT | CX    | CY    | R    |
|-----|-------|-------|------|-----|-------|-------|------|
| 1   | 20.50 | 12.00 | 1.40 | 8   | 7.75  | 19.36 | 1.80 |
| 2   | 19.36 | 7.75  | 1.20 | 9   | 12.00 | 20.50 | 1.70 |
| 3   | 12.00 | 3.50  | 1.10 | 10  | 16.25 | 19.36 | 1.60 |
| 4   | 7.75  | 4.64  | 1.30 | 11  | 19.36 | 16.25 | 1.50 |
| 5   | 4.64  | 7.75  | 1.50 | 12  | 15.00 | 13.00 | 1.00 |
| 6   | 3.50  | 12.00 | 1.60 | 13  | 13.00 | 15.50 | 0.90 |
| 7   | 4.64  | 16.25 | 1.70 |     |       |       |      |

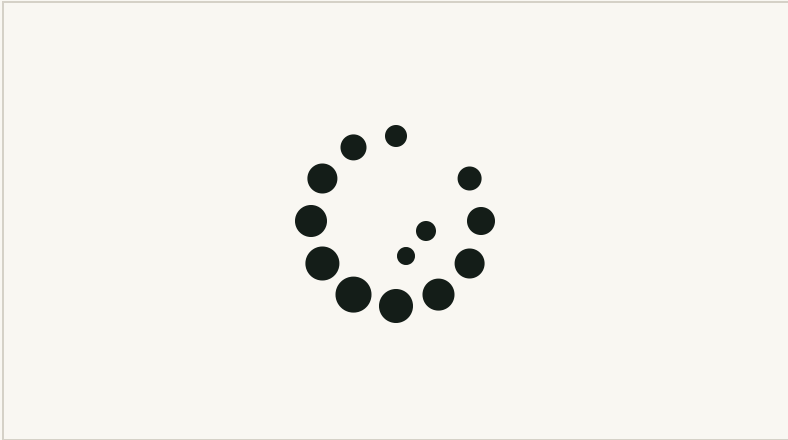
24-unit frame · ring 12,12 r 8.5 · seats every 30° counterclockwise from dot 1 · open seat 16.25, 4.64 (60°) · gradient 3,21 → 21,3 · #3D8B68 → #03F5F2

# Gradient in the masthead. Ink on paper. Paper on Night. Always still.

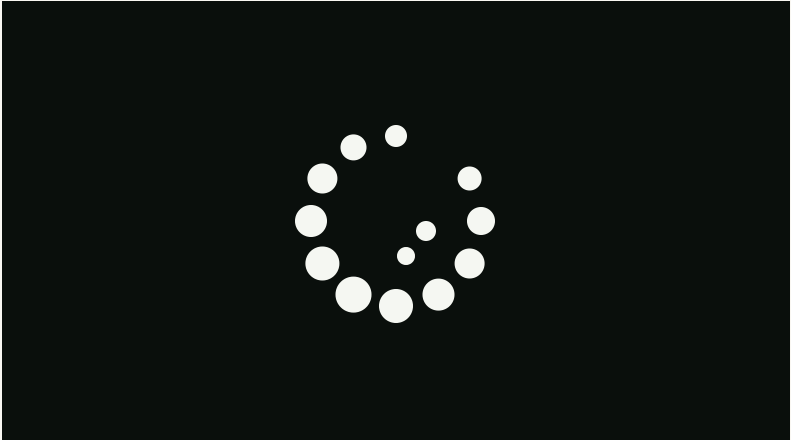
GRADIENT · MASTHEAD, FAVICON, COVERS



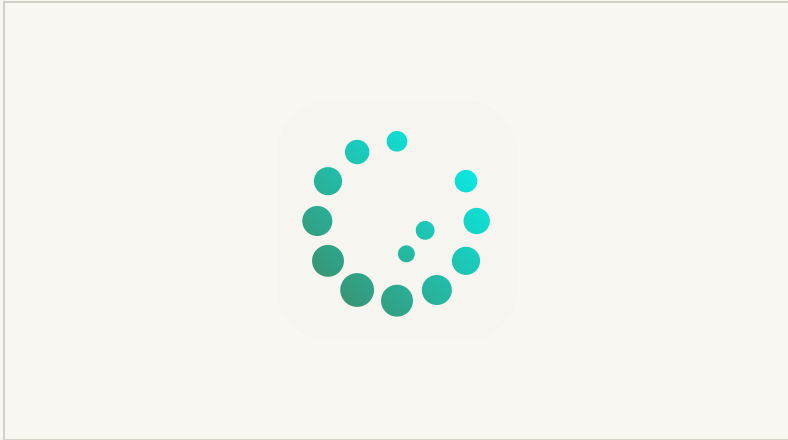
INK · RUNNING LOCKUPS ON PAPER



PAPER · ON NIGHT



FAVICON TILE · WARM WHITE



**Static.** The mark does not move. The 22-second spin retires with the Porcelain register. The open seat is the meaning; a rotating mark has no open seat.

**Lockup.** Mark at 24 px, 10 px gap, "DORA Research" in Geist 500 at 15 px on one line.

**Ownership.** The lab's mark. It signs research and the company page. It never identifies Zora inside the product.

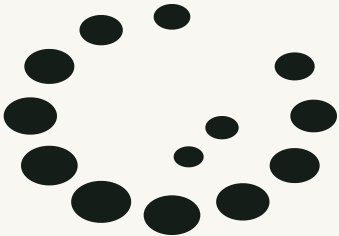
**Clear space.** Half the mark's height on all four sides, measured from the outer edge of the largest dots.

**Minimum.** 20 px alone on screen, 22 px inside a lockup, 6 mm in print. The favicon tile handles 16 px with heavier dot radii.

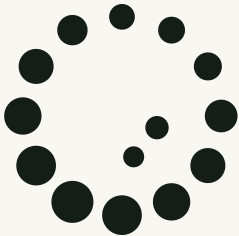
**Reserved color.** Living Green #3D8B68 and Signal Cyan #03F5F2 exist only inside the gradient. On Night, cyan survives only as the 6 px dot beside Zora's name.

# The geometry, the gradient, and the resting angle are fixed.

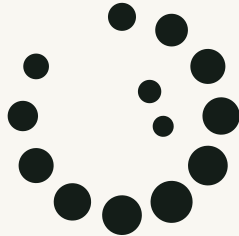
The only permitted changes are the three variants and uniform scaling.



× STRETCHED



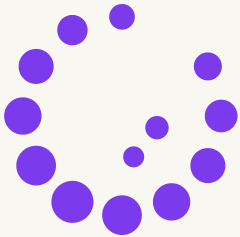
× SEAT FILLED



× RE-ANGLED



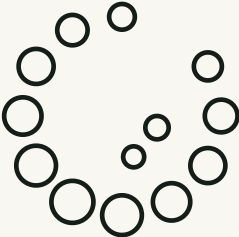
× GLOW, PULSE, SPIN



× RECOLORED



× GRADIENT GROUND

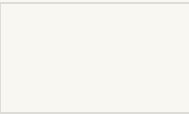
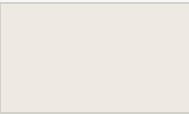
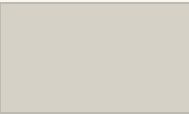


× OUTLINED



× AS A PRODUCT MARK

# Warm paper, one ink, one green.

|                                                                                     |                                            |                      |                                                                                                  |                        |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
|    | <b>Paper</b><br>ground                     | #F9F7F2              | The page. Warm, not cream.                                                                       | ground                 |
|    | <b>Evidence</b><br>recessed                | #EDEAE2              | Quoted sources, code, logs, benchmark tables. Always bounded by a Rule hairline.                 | <b>1.1</b><br>vs Paper |
|    | <b>Ink</b><br>text                         | #141D18              | Display, body, diagrams, the ink-only mark.                                                      | <b>16.1</b><br>AAA     |
|   | <b>Pencil</b><br>secondary                 | #566460              | Secondary text, captions, interactive borders.                                                   | <b>5.8</b><br>AA       |
|  | <b>Rule</b><br>hairline                    | #D5D1C7              | Hairlines only. Never text, never the sole boundary of a control.                                | <b>1.4</b><br>non-text |
|  | <b>Living Green Deep</b><br>the one accent | #2A6449              | Links, the primary action, the focus ring, the one line in a figure, provenance markers.         | <b>6.5</b><br>AA       |
|  | <b>Risk</b><br>status                      | #AD3547              | Risk text and a 2 px keyline on a risk callout. Never a fill.                                    | <b>5.8</b><br>AA       |
|  | <b>Mark gradient</b><br>reserved           | #3D8B68 ·<br>#03F5F2 | Inside the thirteen-dot mark only. Undarkened Living Green fails AA as text and is never a link. | <b>mark</b><br>only    |

Ratios are WCAG 2 contrast against Paper. The one dark section on a lab page is painted Night Floor #0A0F0C and uses the Night tokens; Living Green Deep on Night Floor measures 2.4 and is not used there.

Display  
Newsreader 500  
64 / 66 · -0.015em · opsz 72

Agents take the work.  
People keep the judgment.

Section  
Newsreader 500  
40 / 46 · -0.012em

Benchmarks first. Products second.

Lede  
Newsreader 400  
22 / 32 · italics for margin  
notes only

If you run AI agents, you are already delegating. Write down where the line is. *This framework proposes one.*

Body  
Geist 400  
17 / 28 · 64 to 72 ch

The lab's research, benchmarks, and frameworks are published before they become products, so anyone can check what it claims against what it ships.

UI  
Geist 500 · 14 / 20

Read the framework

Benchmark DR-BM-001

Meta  
Plex Mono 500 · 12 / 16 ·  
+0.06em · caps

DR-FW-001 · V0.1 · 2026-09-13 · DRAFT FOR REVIEW

Data  
Plex Mono 400 · 13 / 20 ·  
tabular

orders-service 2.31.0 · migration 0187 · 61,000,000 rows · lock 14 min

# Rules, not cards. The page arrives finished.

- 01

**Rules, not cards.** Structure is 1 px hairlines on an 8 px rhythm and one recessed Evidence surface for source material. Radius 0 on containers, 2 px at most on controls. No shadows, no glass, no tinted section backgrounds, no white plates on grey.
- 02

**Left-anchored, with a live margin.** A 680 px reading column set left of center; the right margin carries figure numbers, footnotes, dates, and citations. Nothing is centered except the mark in the masthead.
- 03

**Every number has a source. Every artifact has an ID.** A specimen header on every benchmark, framework, and brief: ID, version, date, evidence. A number without a footnote does not ship.
- 04

**The page arrives finished, like the brief.** No fade-ups, staggers, parallax, counters, chart draw-on, typing, or streaming. Three durations, 120, 160, and 240 ms, one easing. The mark is static.
- 05

**One Night section per page is where paper hands to Zora.** A single full-bleed block painted Night Floor carries the real product at real density: hard rectangular edge, no device frame, no tilt, captioned in mono with a figure number, a place, and a time.

Never on paper: a chat input or chat bubble, a sparkle, an avatar, copilot framing, italic display as decoration, motion on the mark, purple, orange, a second green, any gradient on a surface, stock photography, an icon set.

# Benchmarks first. Products second.

Every product begins as a question, becomes a benchmark, is shaped by a framework, and only then becomes something a CTO can use. Each step is published with an ID, a version, and its evidence.

1 · QUESTION

What work in an engineering organization should an agent take?

2 · BENCHMARK

How often was the agent's call the one the person made?

3 · FRAMEWORK

The Accountability Line, v0.1

4 · PRODUCT

Zora, advising at Proposed today, acting at Reported within a year

| TYPE      | ID FORM        | WHAT IT COMMITS TO                                                                       |
|-----------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Framework | DR-FW-####     | A published position with tests. Versioned; changes are decisions with names on them.    |
| Benchmark | DR-BM-####     | A measured result with sample size, method, and the data or a reason it is withheld.     |
| Note      | DR-NT-####     | A short finding or a correction. Dated, never silently edited.                           |
| Brief     | customer's own | Zora's daily output. Never published by the lab; cited only with the customer's consent. |

# Agents take the work you can undo. People keep the work you have to answer for.

Four tiers by three questions: how much can go wrong if the agent is wrong, how cheaply it can be undone, and who is answerable afterward. A task is promoted toward Silent and demoted toward Reserved; the framework never says up or down.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>TIER 1</div> <div>Silent</div> <div>Work an agent does on its own and does not need to mention. Checked in aggregate, not item by item.</div> <div>TEST</div> <div>If the agent gets this wrong, does anyone need to be told, and does the next run overwrite the mistake? No and yes.</div> | <div>TIER 2</div> <div>Reported</div> <div>Done on its own, then told to a named person with the evidence and the undo path. A rule a person wrote.</div> <div>TEST</div> <div>Can a named person with ordinary access undo this in minutes, and is the agent applying a rule that person wrote? Both yes.</div> | <div>TIER 3</div> <div>Proposed</div> <div>The agent prepares the decision and a named person makes it: evidence, options, cost to undo, who can say yes.</div> <div>TEST</div> <div>Does undoing this take a rollback, a customer notice, or another team's time, or does it change what a person is responsible for? Either yes.</div> | <div>TIER 4</div> <div>Reserved</div> <div>Stays with people. The cost lands on someone who did not decide, or the answer depends on what no system records.</div> <div>TEST</div> <div>Would you be comfortable telling a customer, an employee, or an auditor that the agent decided? No.</div> |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

# Reversibility before capability.

- 01

**Reversibility before capability.** The question is never whether the agent can do the work. It is what it costs to undo on the day the agent is wrong.
- 02

**Every action has a named person.** Not a team, not a role, a name. Delegate actions, never accountability.
- 03

**People write the rule; the agent applies it.** If it is not written down, the agent does not have it. When unsure, report.
- 04

**Promotion is earned in shadow and is slow. Demotion is instant.** On the organization's own log, never on a vendor's benchmark or how the demo felt.
- 05

**Conversations with people stay with people.** The agent tells a manager that work is drifting; the manager talks to the engineer.

STATUS · HELD

The tier is right but the safety net is not there yet. The task waits.

STATUS · SHADOW

The agent logs what it would have done beside what the person did. The disagreement rate is the promotion evidence.

STATUS · LIVE

The action runs at its tier and appears in the next brief with the rule that fired and who wrote it. Demotion is one message.

ZORA TODAY

The record is Silent. Every recommendation is Proposed. She names the decider and does not decide.

# Plain, published, and willing to say what it does not know.

| WHERE              | LINE                                            |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Lab hero           | Agents take the work. People keep the judgment. |
| Research           | Benchmarks first. Products second.              |
| The mark's caption | Thirteen agents. One job each.                  |
| Delegation         | She takes the task. You keep the call.          |
| Beta invitation    | Give Zora one night. Read the brief at 06:00.   |
| Footer             | DORA Research. An applied AI lab.               |

- The lab writes as "we". It names the work agents take and the work people keep in the same sentence.
- Say AI and agents. Never copilot, assistant, chatbot, teammate, digital employee.
- Every claim carries an artifact ID or a source and a date. A number without one is cut.
- Mark what is unknown as unknown. "We have not tested this" is a complete sentence.
- Write for the company's real constraints. Never assume a budget the reader does not have.
- Two beats, then stop. Short declarative. Full stop. Second declarative. Or one line alone.
- The lab never speaks in Zora's first person. She speaks for herself.

# She reads the night. You read the brief.

Zora is an AI agent: a technical director who reports to the CTO. Overnight she reads what Linear, GitHub, Datadog, PagerDuty, and Slack recorded, connects it to what the team decided, and finishes the brief by 06:00. Today she advises with evidence. Within a year she will hold a deploy, open a ticket, or page the on-call, on the CTO's authority.

| TITLE                                                                                                                                           | REPORTS TO                                                                                  | MECHANISM                                                                                                                                | PRESENCE                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Technical director and chief of staff</b><br><br>Depth across every discipline in the room, plus the executive's memory of every commitment. | <b>The CTO or VP Engineering</b><br><br>One accountable person, who is also the daily user. | <b>Memory</b><br><br>She connects the ticket to the decision to the deploy so the brief can say why. How she works, not what she is for. | <b>A name, a voice, a 6 px dot</b><br><br>Never a face, an avatar, a robot, or an orb. Zora is she, the subject of her sentences. |

ZORA, IN HER OWN WORDS

I am Zora. I report to the CTO. Overnight I read what the organization produced: the deploys, the alerts, the tickets, the threads. At 06:00 you get a finished brief: who was affected, what led to it, what we change, and where else it applies. Then I stay in the room for the questions. I will tell you what I know and what I do not.

# Three questions. Answered before the meeting.

LAST NIGHT

## What happened last night?

Who was affected, how it was mitigated, and what is still open.

PROJECTS

## Where are we with this project, and why?

The decision, the dependency, and the reason, with the record attached.

RISK

## Where are we most at risk?

Where the same conditions exist, what to do there, and who decides.

TWO ENEMIES

## The status meeting that reconstructs last week.

The past you should already have. The brief exists so the meeting does not have to.

## Being caught off guard.

The future you should have seen. The conditions were there on Tuesday; the brief says so on Tuesday.

ONE FEELING

## It is 06:04. The CTO has finished the brief. They are calm and in control, and they know exactly which question to ask first.

If the reader cannot feel it, the work is not finished.

# Impact first. Then conditions. Then what we change. Then where else.

The voice is modeled on a real technical director the founder worked with. He rose from principal engineer, could talk to DevOps, SRE, architects, and senior developers in their own dialects, and answered "what happened last night?" the same way every time. That structure is now Zora's.

|                                                                                       |                                                                                             |                                                                                                      |                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01                                                                                    | 02                                                                                          | 03                                                                                                   | 04                                                                                        |
| <b>Impact and outcome</b>                                                             | <b>Conditions</b>                                                                           | <b>What we change</b>                                                                                | <b>Where else</b>                                                                         |
| Who was affected, how it was mitigated, and what is still open. Before anything else. | The circumstances that let it happen. No blame, no speculation. Unknowns marked as unknown. | How the organization operates differently so it does not recur. Sized to this company's constraints. | Other places the same conditions exist, and what to do there. Then she names the decider. |

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><div><div></div><div>Zora</div></div><div><div>Last night</div><div>Projects</div><div>Risk</div></div><div>COMPILED 06:00 · 2026-09-10 · DEMO</div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <div>NIGHT BRIEF · 2026-09-10 · 06:00 · 8 RECORDS</div> <div><div>EU order writes failed for 14 minutes overnight. Mitigated at 02:55, and the same pattern is queued for tonight.</div><div><div>01</div><div><div>Impact and outcome</div><div>Between 02:41 and 02:55 every write to the orders table in eu-west-1 was blocked. Reads carried on, so the service-wide error rate peaked at 34% while checkout writes timed out at 30 seconds. Around 180 checkout attempts failed. About 140 were retried by the client and completed by 03:10; the remaining 40 are listed in ORD-1187 for reconciliation this morning. No data was lost. Whether any customer was charged without an order, or charged again on retry, is unverified: the payment provider is not among my sources. PagerDuty paged Priya Nair at 02:44; she found the blocking index build at 02:54 and canceled it, and the service recovered within the minute.</div></div></div><div><div>02</div><div><div>Conditions</div><div>The 02:30 unattended deploy of orders-service 2.31.0 rolled the image out first and started the migration job at 02:41. Migration 0187 adds an index on orders.customer_id. It was written without CONCURRENTLY, so Postgres held a SHARE lock on orders for as long as the build ran: every insert, update, and delete waited, and reads went through. On staging that table has 40,000 rows and the index built in under a second. In production it has 61 million rows, and the build held the lock for 14 minutes before Priya canceled it. The migration checklist does not mention lock behavior on large tables, and CI has no step that flags non-concurrent index creation.</div></div></div></div> | <div>EVIDENCE · 8 RECORDS</div> <div><div><div>GitHub · 2026-09-09 · 16:18 · Tomas · Billing</div><div>PR #4730 merged to billing-service: CREATE INDEX on invoices.account_id without CONCURRENTLY.</div></div><div><div>Linear · 2026-09-09 · 16:20 · Tomas · Billing</div><div>BIL-402: migration 0043 queued for the 2026-09-11 02:30 unattended window.</div></div><div><div>GitHub · 02:30 · Platform</div><div>Nightly workflow began the orders-service 2.31.0 deploy; the migration job for 0187 started at 02:41.</div></div><div><div>Datadog · 02:41 · Reliability</div><div>p99 for POST /orders rose from 310 ms to over 30 s; 5xx rate reached 34% by 02:43.</div></div><div><div>PagerDuty · 02:44 · Priya Nair</div><div>Incident 2291 triggered; acknowledged at 02:46.</div></div><div><div>Slack · 02:54 · Priya Nair</div><div>#inc-2291: pg_locks shows CREATE INDEX on orders holding a SHARE lock since 02:41, canceling it now.</div></div></div> |

03 What we change

I recommend three changes, all small. First, a CI check that fails any migration adding an index without CONCURRENTLY to a table it did not create, or running a CONCURRENTLY build inside a transaction block, which Postgres refuses. No threshold and no data feed; it is a regex and about ten lines. Second, one line added to the migration checklist: state the production row count and the expected lock. Third, any migration touching orders, customers, or payments runs in the 10:00 attended window with the author present. None of this needs new budget or new tooling. I have not opened tickets or changed anything; who owns each of these is your call.

04 Where else

The same conditions exist in two places. **Migration 0043 in billing-service, merged yesterday and queued for tonight's 02:30 window, builds an index on invoices.account\_id without CONCURRENTLY.** That table has 22 million rows in production, so tonight would look like last night. I would hold it or move it to the attended window; that is your decision, not mine. Second, the analytics repo runs its own migrations through Airflow at 01:00 and never passes through orders CI. Two reviewers approved 0187 and would have approved 0043; the checklist is the exposure, not any one person.

EVIDENCE · CONTINUED

**Datadog** · 02:55 · Reliability  
5xx rate under 0.2% by 02:55:40; p99 back to 340 ms by 02:56. No further alerts.

**Linear** · 03:12 · Priya Nair  
ORD-1187 created: reconcile 40 checkout attempts that failed between 02:41 and 02:55, priority high, unassigned.

WHAT THE FRAME SHOWS

Persistent chrome. Source, time, and owner on every record. Two signal colors, each paired with a word: Mint for the one action, Rose for the one risk. Everything else is Ash. The brief arrives whole; the dialogue is where life is spent.

QUESTIONS

CTO If I hold billing 0043 tonight, what slips, and who needs to know?

ZORA Nothing customer-facing slips. 0043 backs the invoice search that ships with the billing release on 2026-09-17; the index can be built with CONCURRENTLY in Friday's 10:00 window and still land four days early. Two people need to know: Priya, who is on call tonight, and Tomas, who owns the billing release. I have not told either. Records: Linear BIL-402, GitHub PR #4730.

- 01
- Impact first, then conditions, then the operating change, then where else.
- 02
- Zora is the subject of the sentence. She reads, she found, she recommends. Not "the platform", not "our AI", not "it".
- 03
- Say AI and agents plainly. Never copilot, assistant, or chatbot. Never a face or a personality bit.
- 04
- Adjectives are measurements. 14 minutes, 61 million rows, 40 checkouts.
- 05
- Every claim carries a record. Name the source and the 24-hour time, or cut the claim.
- 06
- Conditions, not blame. Never a person's failing, never a guess at intent. Mark what is unknown as unknown.
- 07
- Two beats, then stop.
- 08
- The brief arrives finished and grounded in this company's constraints. No streaming, no thinking theater, no advice that assumes a budget the reader does not have.

USE

Zora, she, her brief · the night brief · AI, agents · an applied AI lab · impact, conditions, what we change, where else · record, evidence, source · owner, decision, deadline · at risk, exposure · hold, mitigated, rollback, on-call · ship faster, break less · throughput, stability, quality · reports to the CTO · judgment, accountability, sign-off · Linear, GitHub, Datadog, PagerDuty, Slack · 24-hour times

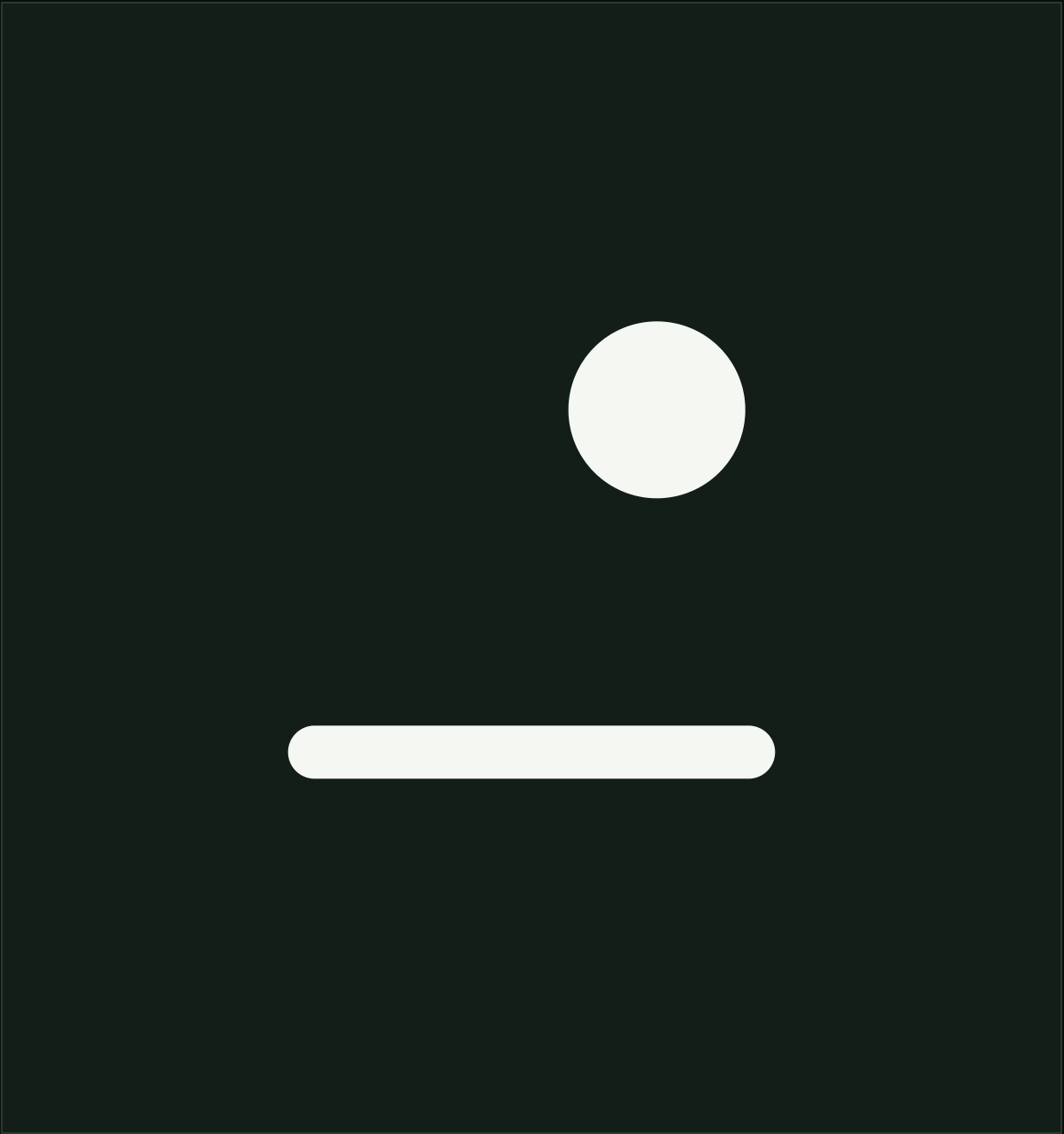
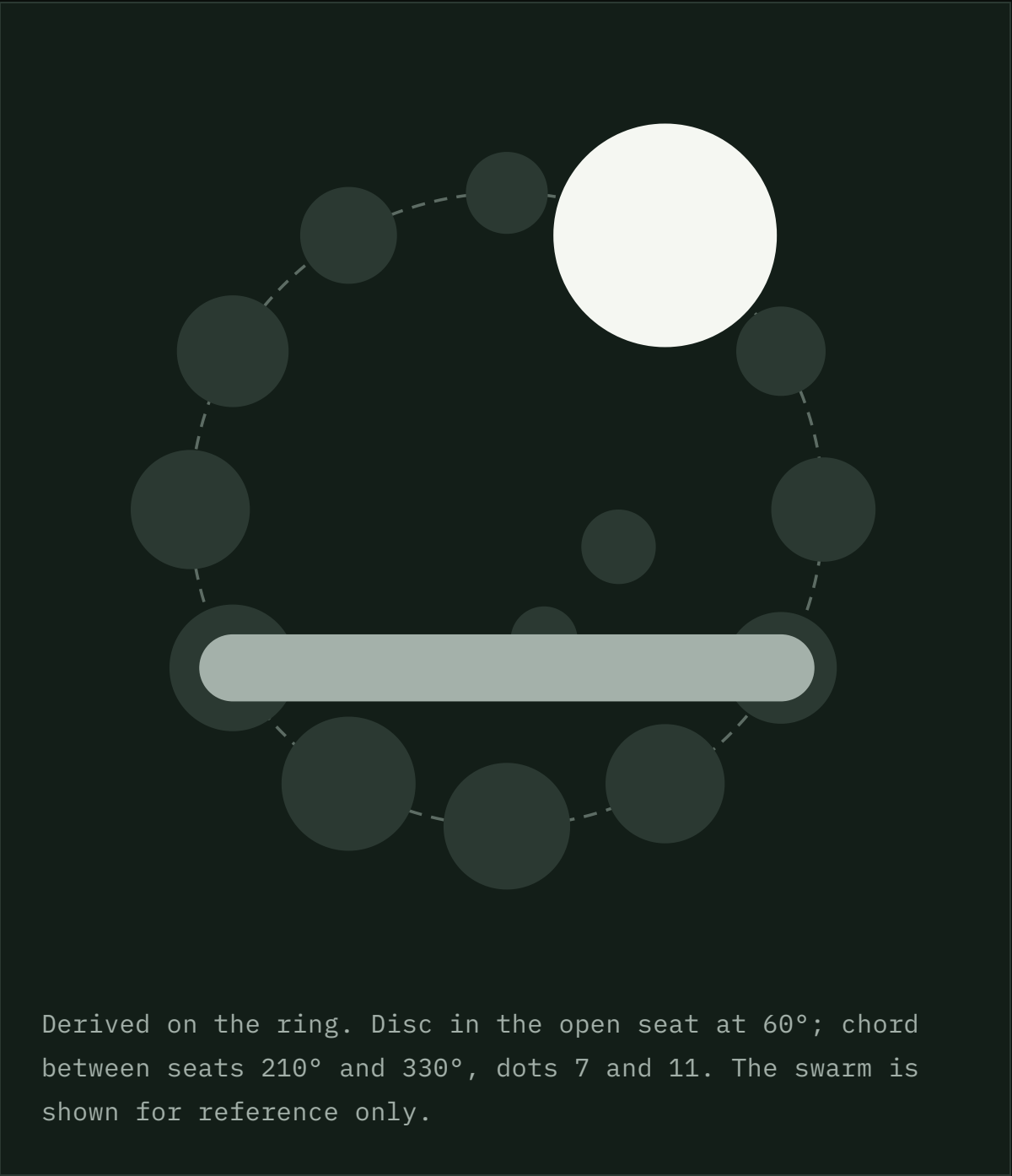
AVOID

copilot, assistant, chatbot, bot, avatar · AI teammate, digital employee · second brain, knowledge base, single pane of glass, command center · insights, actionable, real-time, surface as a verb · AI-powered, intelligent, smart, magic, seamless, never sleeps · unlock, empower, leverage, 10x, revolutionary · root cause · we think, probably, likely · thinking..., generating..., chat with your data · it, for Zora · am/pm times · em dashes · exclamation marks · emoji

# Typical AI SaaS, and the house voice.

| BEFORE                                                                                                                                                                                             | AFTER                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Supercharge your engineering team with AI-powered insights! Our intelligent copilot analyzes millions of data points across your entire stack to surface what matters, so you can ship 10x faster. | Zora reads Linear, GitHub, Datadog, and Slack overnight. At 06:00 she tells you who was affected, why, and what changes. Ship faster. Break less.                                                                                                         |
| Never miss a thing. Your second brain remembers everything so you don't have to.                                                                                                                   | Memory is how she works, not what she is for. Zora connects the ticket to the decision to the deploy so the brief can say why.                                                                                                                            |
| Autonomous AI agents that take action across your stack: automatically fix issues, close tickets, and keep your team in flow, with no human in the loop required.                                  | Today she advises with evidence. Within a year she will hold a deploy, open a ticket, or page the on-call, on your authority and with your sign-off. We will say which, and when, before she does it.                                                     |
| Start your free trial today and unlock the full potential of your engineering org. No credit card required. Join thousands of teams already transforming how they work!                            | The beta starts with one night. Connect Linear, GitHub, Datadog, PagerDuty, and Slack in the afternoon; the brief is on your desk at 06:00. Zora is working with a small number of CTOs, and we will tell you plainly if she is not ready for your setup. |

# One specialist takes the open seat.



Derived on the lab's ring and never redrawing it. One flat disc stands in the swarm's open seat. One chord joins two seats on the ring and is the line of evidence she stands on. The figure is then placed in the frame by a fixed offset every product mark shares. Never center the disc; the 60° offset is the mark.

|           |                                                                              |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Disc      | <code>cx 16.25 · cy 6.64 · r 3.0</code>                                      |
| Chord     | <code>x 4.64 → 19.36 · y 18.25</code><br><code>1.8 thick · caps r 0.9</code> |
| Ratios    | Chord 2.75× the disc diameter, never under 2.4×. Thickness 0.3×, never more. |
| Placement | Derive at the ring, translate +2 in y.                                       |



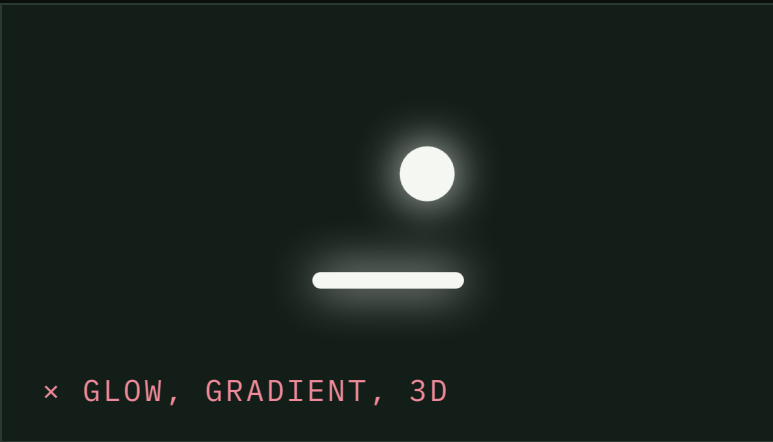
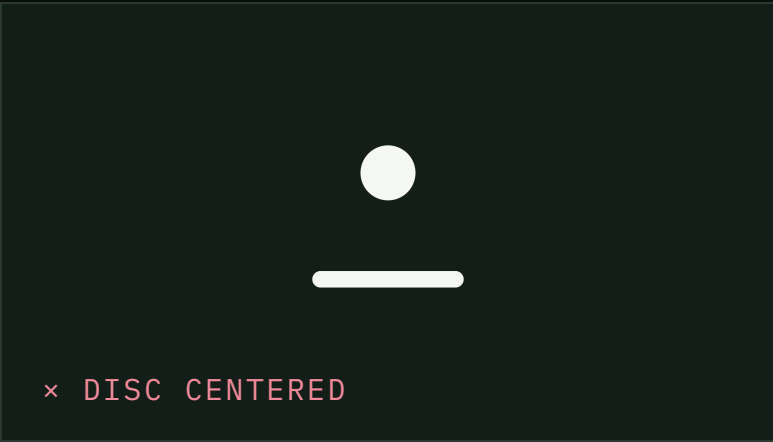
**One color.** `currentColor` everywhere. On paper the mark is Ink. On Night the disc is Paper and the chord dims to Ash from 24 px upward.

**Never colored.** The disc never takes Mint, Signal Cyan, the lab gradient, or a status color. A colored disc on the dark canvas reads as an LED.

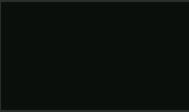
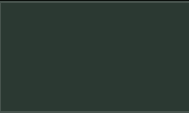
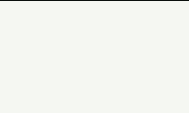
**Lockup.** Mark at 24 px, the word Zora in Geist 500, and on Night the 6 px cyan dot: steady while watching, one blink on a real ingest, Ash when disconnected.

THE FAMILY RULE

A DORA product mark is one flat disc, radius 3.0, in the swarm's open seat, plus straight chords of the swarm's ring, 1.8 thick with round caps, joining ring seats. Products differ only in which chords they draw. No second disc, no arc, no ring, no color on the disc. Every figure is placed in the 24 frame by the same fixed offset. Zora's figure is the level chord. The next specialist might join 90° and 210°, or draw two chords. It will never close the ring.



# Silence is nominal.

|                                                                                     |                                   |         |                                                                                                                     |                  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
|    | <b>Night Floor</b><br>canvas      | #0A0F0C | The canvas and the black point every film plate is graded to.                                                       | ground           |
|    | <b>Raised</b><br>panel            | #131E18 | Evidence panels and row hover. Separation is a 1 px Line, never a shadow.                                           | 1.1<br>vs canvas |
|    | <b>Line</b><br>hairline           | #2B3932 | Hairlines, table rules, panel borders.                                                                              | 1.6<br>non-text  |
|    | <b>Line strong</b><br>perceivable | #5D6C64 | Focus rings, input borders, any boundary a user must perceive.                                                      | 3.5<br>UI        |
|  | <b>Paper</b><br>text              | #F5F7F2 | Text. The same paper the lab prints on, seen in the dark.                                                           | 17.9<br>AAA      |
|  | <b>Ash</b><br>secondary           | #A4B1AA | Secondary, provenance, nominal status. Most of the page.                                                            | 8.7<br>AAA       |
|  | <b>Mint</b><br>the one action     | #67BF99 | The one recommended action, the one evidence link. One per viewport, paired with a word. Never a glow or a surface. | 8.7<br>AAA       |
|  | <b>Rose</b><br>the one risk       | #F08A9A | The one named risk, the hold state. Text or a 2 px rule with a word. Never a fill. One per viewport.                | 8.1<br>AAA       |
|  | <b>Signal Cyan</b><br>the dot     | #03F5F2 | A 6 px dot beside the name Zora. Never larger than 8 px, never text, never in the film grade.                       | dot<br>only      |

Display  
Geist 500  
44 / 48 · -0.02em · never  
centered

# EU order writes failed for 14 minutes overnight.

Section  
Geist 500  
22 / 28 · mono index in Ash

## 02 Conditions

Body  
Geist 400  
16 / 26 · 60 to 68 ch · tnum

On staging that table has 40,000 rows and the index built in under a second. In production it has 61 million rows.

UI  
Geist 500 · 14 / 20

Hold migration 0043

Queued for tonight

Provenance  
Plex Mono 400 · 12 / 16 · Ash

Datadog · 02:41 · orders-service · eu-west-1 · Reliability

Timecode  
Plex Mono 500 · 11 / 16 · caps

COMPILED 06:00 · 2026-09-10 · 8 RECORDS

### MOTION

**One curve.** cubic-bezier(.2, 0, 0, 1). Three durations: 120 ms state, 160 ms arrive, 240 ms layout.

**The brief arrives whole** in a 160 ms fade with an 8 px rise. If it is not ready, yesterday's brief stands with its timestamp. Never a compiling line, never a pulse.

**Views cut.** Navigation between the three questions is a hard cut. Hover is a value step, Ash to Paper, never a glow or a lift.

**The mark is static.** The cyan dot moves only for a real event.

**Film** may push once from 1.00 to 1.04 over 8 to 12 seconds and never loops.

**Reduced motion:** everything to 0 ms, dot solid. Nothing a reader needs depends on motion.

# Film is the ground. The brief is the protagonist.

- 01

**The brief is the protagonist, and it arrives finished.** One column, four numbered parts in fixed order, one cut. No streaming, no typewriter, no thinking state. Life is spent after the brief, in the dialogue: silence, then the whole answer.
- 02

**Film is the ground, not a card.** Plates are graded to Night Floor so the machine's shadows become the page. No frames, mockups, bezels, shadows, or glows. Screens are shot in camera at real scale.
- 03

**Silence is nominal.** Mint for the one action, Rose for the one risk, one of each per viewport, each paired with a word. Everything else is Ash. A screen with no color on it is the good news.
- 04

**Provenance is the system's voice.** Every claim carries a Plex Mono source, time, and owner. It opens in place, never in a modal. Numbers without a source do not appear.
- 05

**One company, two grounds.** Same type, same signals, same mark family, same paper. The lab is Paper in daylight; Zora is the same Paper read in the dark. The UI never inherits the film grade.

Layout: the strip is always present at first paint. Brief in columns 3 to 9, evidence rail in 10 to 12, plate behind all 12. Radius 0 on plates and panels, 4 px on controls. Depth is a 1 px Line and one luminance step.

# 06:00. The brief is finished.

SpaceX points the camera at the rocket. Waymo points it at the car in traffic. DORA points it at a CTO at 06:00, reading a brief that was written while they slept. Person, brief, systems, consequence, in that order. Engineering documentary: real machine, real scale, cut not looped, licensed masters only.

SHOT 01 · 05:58      KITCHEN

The CTO, coffee, a laptop already open. The brief is on screen before they sit down. Nothing is typed.

Available light, tungsten.  
Handheld, close.

SHOT 02 · 06:01      THE PRODUCT

The night brief at real scale on a real screen. Four numbered parts. The reader's eyes move; the interface does not.

Macro on the display, no screen replacement.

SHOT 03 · 02:41      THE SYSTEMS

A p99 graph climbing. A page arriving on a phone on a nightstand. A terminal holding a lock. Nobody in the room.

Documentary inserts, graded to Night Floor.

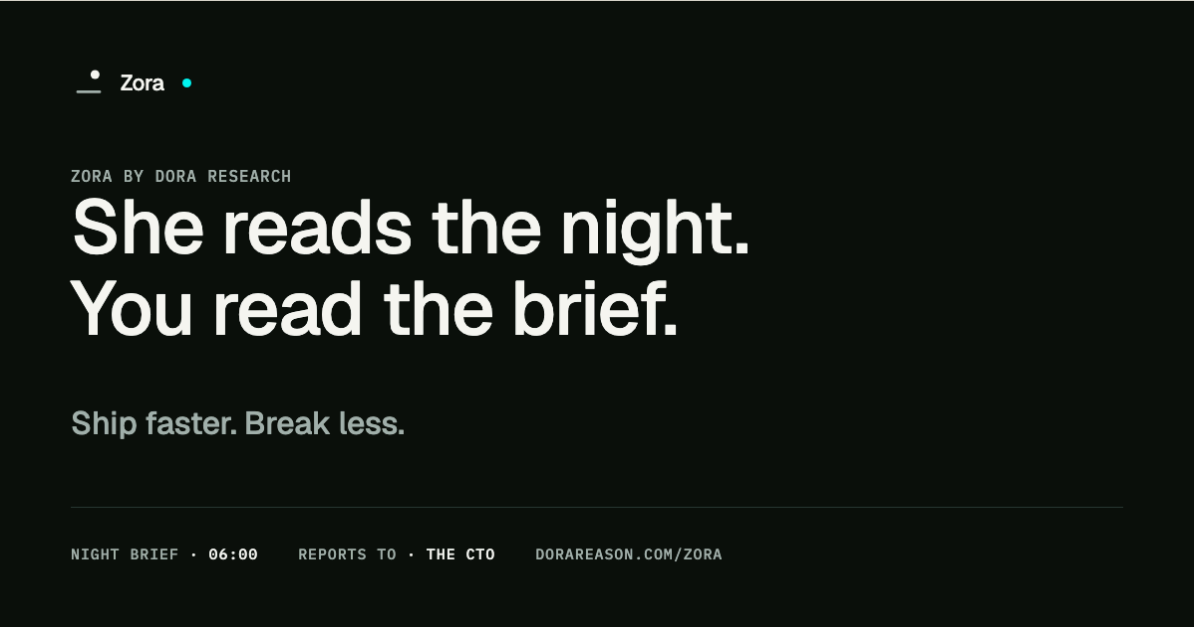
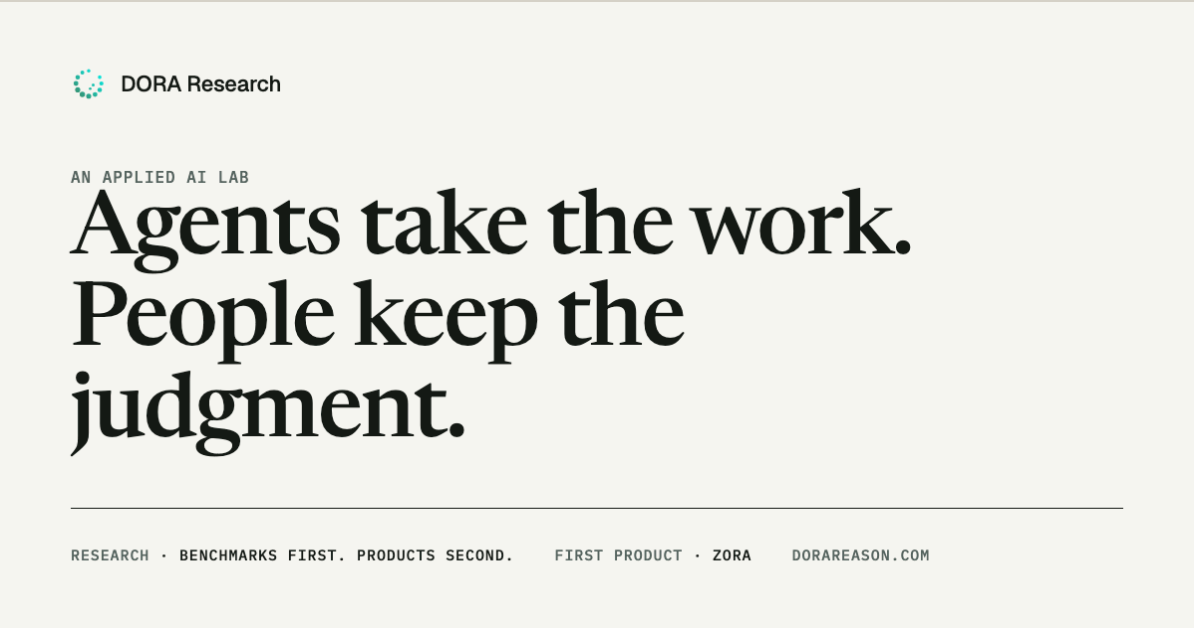
SHOT 04 · 09:30      INCIDENT REVIEW

Four people and a wall of evidence. The conditions are on the wall. No name is on the wall.

Wide, still, observational. Cut before anyone performs.

# The brand where it ships.

|            |                                                                                                                                                              |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Site       | dorareason.com. The lab leads: Company and Research on Paper, Zora on Night on her own page. One Night section on the company page hands off to the product. |
| Title tags | DORA Research · An applied AI lab<br>Research · DORA Research<br>Zora · She reads the night. You read the brief.                                             |
| Navigation | Research · Zora · Company · Request private beta                                                                                                             |
| Footer     | DORA Research. An applied AI lab. · © 2026                                                                                                                   |
| Favicon    | The swarm on a Warm White tile. Zora's page may carry her own once the mark is adopted.                                                                      |
| Beta       | hello@dorareason.com, subject "Zora private beta", until a form exists.                                                                                      |



SOCIAL CARDS · 1200 × 630 · THE LAB LINE ON PAPER, ZORA'S LINE ON NIGHT

# Versioned like software. Rewritten on the record.

|          |                                                                                                                         |
|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DECIDED  | Confirmed by the founder in the interview of 13 September 2026.<br>Changing it is a new decision, logged with a reason. |
| PROPOSED | Drafted for this version and not yet adopted. Build to it; expect amendments.                                           |
| OPEN     | A known gap or an unanswered question, listed so it is not forgotten.                                                   |

PRECEDENCE

|    |                                                                     |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 | The founder's decisions, in the changelog, with their dates.        |
| 02 | The brand book at its current version.                              |
| 03 | DESIGN.md in the repository, rewritten from the book.               |
| 04 | The live site, ground truth for what exists today and nothing else. |

OPEN ITEMS

**Zora, the name.** Commission a trademark search in software and services.

**Sign-offs.** Every Proposed item, and the framework draft. Adopt, amend, or retire, each with a changelog row.

**Film.** Commission the four shots. The site carries no plate until they exist.

**Print color.** No CMYK or Pantone recipes yet. Proof against hex; never convert arithmetically.

**The framework's floor.** Define what "ready for Reported" means, or publish that the lab does not yet know.

SUPERSEDED, DO NOT REGRESS

A prediction-market operator with AI operations underneath. Secure AI teammates for infrastructure operations. A consumer personal-memory organizer. A second brain for work with the lab as a byline. The thirteen-dot mark did not change through any of them and does not change now.



# DORA Research. An applied AI lab.

Agents take the work. People keep the judgment.